Survey Session Report

Sales Team Attrition Insights Survey

SESSION CREATOR	John Doe
SESSION DATE RANGE	September 30, 2026 - October 1, 2026
SESSION TYPE	Survey
PARTICIPANT IDENTITY	Identified
PARTICIPANTS	50
COMPLETION RATE	100%

SESSION DESCRIPTION

Survey to uncover why sales team members leave or consider leaving — covering leadership support, compensation and recognition, career growth, workload balance, and team collaboration.

CONFIDENTIALITY LEVEL
Confidential - Internal Use Only

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Overview

EXECUTIVE OVERVIEW

The survey reveals that a significant portion of the sales team harbors doubts about their future with the organization, with only about 34% feeling highly likely (scores 6-10) to remain at their roles in 12 months. Common drivers of attrition include leadership support, workload balance, and team collaboration issues, demonstrating systemic challenges impacting retention. Participants also express concerns about limited clarity on career progression, compensation recognition, and trust in leadership's responsiveness, highlighting areas needing targeted improvement. Overall, the responses depict a team that values recognition and development but feels constrained by operational and cultural barriers.

KEY FINDINGS

Leadership support and communication quality are central to retention concerns.

A broad consensus indicates that lack of support and poor communication from leadership significantly influence employees' willingness to stay, as reflected in the high response shares for these drivers and comments about untrustworthy leadership practices.

Source Questions: Which area most drives sales team attrition in your experience? · How well does sales leadership communicate decisions that affect your quota, territory, or targets?

Workload and work-life balance are prominent reasons for dissatisfaction and attrition.

Participants frequently cite burnout, excessive after-hours work, and toxic cross-region competition as major obstacles, supported by 26-28% of responses and follow-up comments emphasizing long hours and unsustainable demands.

Source Questions: Which area most drives sales team attrition in your experience? · How sustainable is your current sales workload and work-life balance?

Career growth uncertainty and lack of structured paths diminish retention.

Over 60% rated clarity of career advancement as low (scores 0–4), with follow-up comments underscoring the need for transparent promotion timelines and leadership publishing clear career ladders.

Source Question: How clear are career growth and promotion paths for someone in your sales role?

Recognition and compensation are perceived as misaligned with contributions, impacting motivation.

Many respondents feel undervalued, especially mid-pack performers, with follow-ups revealing that recognition favors top performers, and delays in commission resolutions contribute to dissatisfaction.

Source Questions: How valued do you feel for the deals and pipeline work you contribute? · Describe one change that would most reduce attrition on this sales team.

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Collaboration issues and territorial dynamics cause friction and erode trust.

Over one-third of responses indicate inconsistent or blocked collaboration, with follow-up samples highlighting specific issues like territorial remaps and poor handoff processes that hinder effective teamwork.

Source Question: Which statement best describes collaboration within the sales team and with CS/SE partners?

WHAT TO WATCH

TENSION

A disconnect exists between participants' recognition of leadership needs and their perception of leadership responsiveness, which could weaken trust and engagement.

UNCERTAINTY

Varying responses about systemic vs. isolated issues suggest organizational complexity that requires further investigation to target effective solutions.

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Detailed Survey Results

Charts show participants' responses to each base survey question. AI-generated summaries draw on those responses and any associated follow-up answers. Follow-up questions explore the reasons, examples, or context behind participants' answers and may vary by participant.

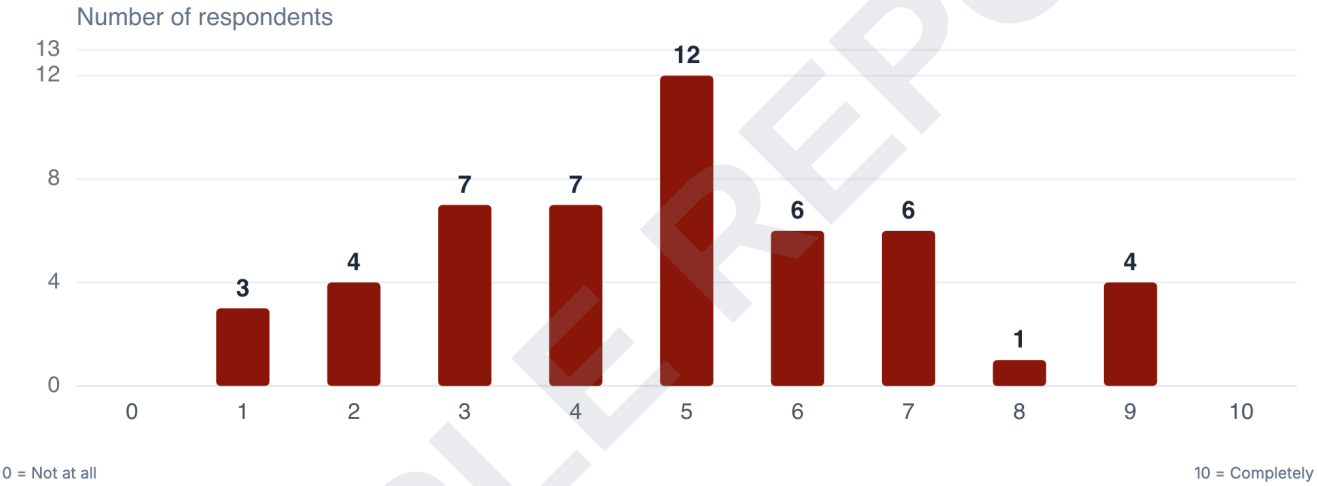
Only base questions are shown in this report. For the questions each participant received and their answers, see the Survey Individual Responses export.

Percentages are rounded to the nearest whole number and may not total 100%.

Q1. Overall, how likely are you to still be on this sales team 12 months from now?

The majority of participants (42%) feel only moderately likely or less to remain, indicating potential retention concerns. Some participants attribute this to leadership issues, workload strain, and unclear growth prospects, which diminish engagement and loyalty. Comments from lower-rated respondents repeatedly mention dissatisfaction with communication, recognition, and workload management, suggesting these are key areas ripe for targeted interventions.

Summary includes follow-up responses.



Answered by 50 respondents

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Q2. Which area most drives sales team attrition in your experience?

Participants cite leadership support and work-life balance as primary drivers of attrition, with notable mentions of inadequate recognition and unclear career paths. Follow-up responses highlight that leadership support lapses and workload pressures, especially during busy periods, diminish motivation. Some responses also emphasize the need for better recognition and a transparent career ladder to foster loyalty.

Summary includes follow-up responses.

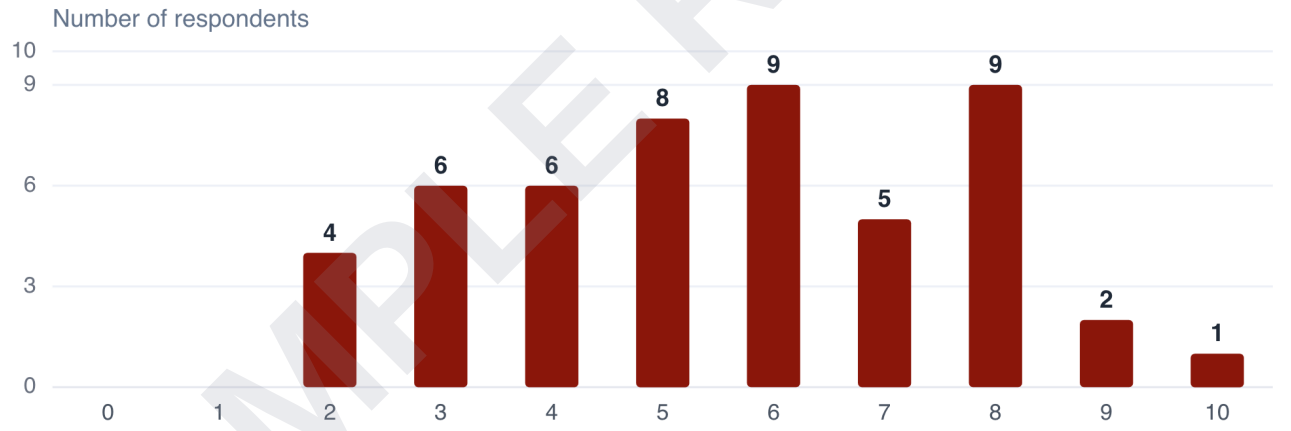
Leadership support	14 of 50 · 28%
Workload / work-life balance	13 of 50 · 26%
Career growth	11 of 50 · 22%
Team collaboration	9 of 50 · 18 %
Compensation & recognition	3 of 50 · 6%

Answered by 50 respondents - Single response

Q3. How well does sales leadership communicate decisions that affect your quota, territory, or targets?

Overall, communication quality is viewed as moderate, with many participants rating it around mid-scale. Follow-up comments reveal a desire for more transparency, faster updates, and clearer rationale behind decisions, which could improve trust. Participants from various regions express frustration over delayed communication, especially during reorganization periods.

Summary includes follow-up responses.



0 = Not well at all

10 = Extremely well

Answered by 50 respondents

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Q4. Describe one change that would most reduce attrition on this sales team.

Participants suggest that clear career ladders, faster compensation resolution, and improved onboarding processes could notably reduce attrition. Comments highlight the importance of transparent promotion timelines, prompt handling of disputes, and consistent leadership communication. Many responses focus on operational improvements rather than cultural changes.

Summary includes follow-up responses.

Answered by 50 respondents · Open-text responses

ILLUSTRATIVE QUOTES

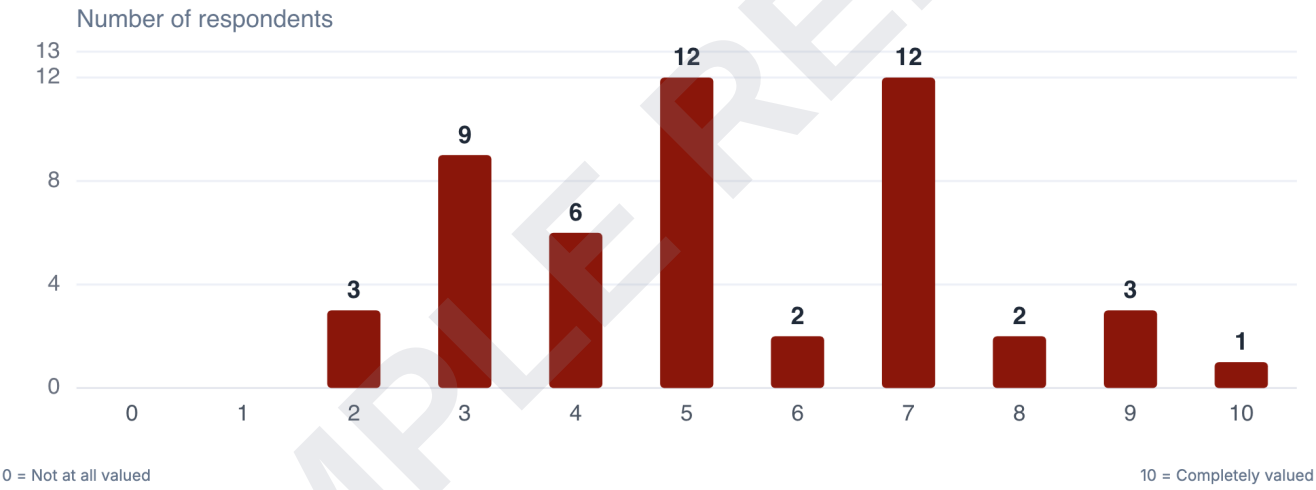
> *"Clearer OTE, accelerators, and faster commission dispute resolution would cut compensation-driven exits. A concrete 30-day change would matter more than another survey."*

> *"I would stay if leadership published a 90-day attrition action plan and actually tracked it. Peers in other pods describe the same pattern."*

Q5. How valued do you feel for the deals and pipeline work you contribute?

Participants' feelings of being valued vary, with some feeling marginally recognized through informal praise or bonuses. Follow-up responses indicate that recognition often favors top performers and that mid-tier contributors feel invisible, impacting motivation. Recognition preferences include career opportunities, coaching feedback, and public acknowledgments.

Summary includes follow-up responses.



Answered by 50 respondents

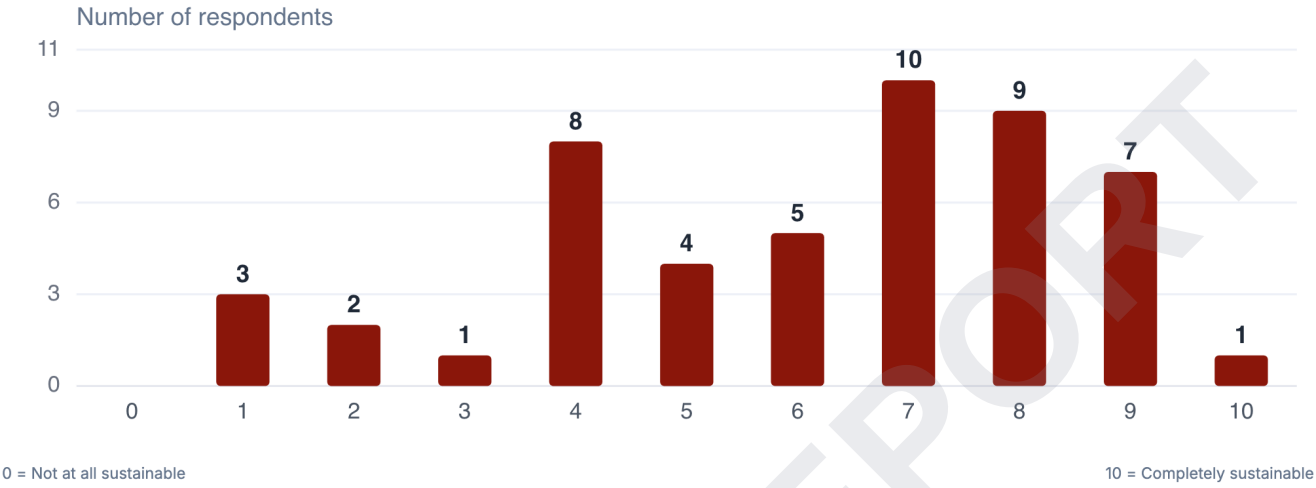
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Q6. How sustainable is your current sales workload and work-life balance?

Many participants describe burnout during peak periods, especially around quarter-end due to long hours and weekend work. Follow-up comments attribute this to high quotas, unclear expectations, and inadequate support. Some suggest a need for workload adjustments, better support, and more predictable schedules to improve sustainability.

Summary includes follow-up responses.

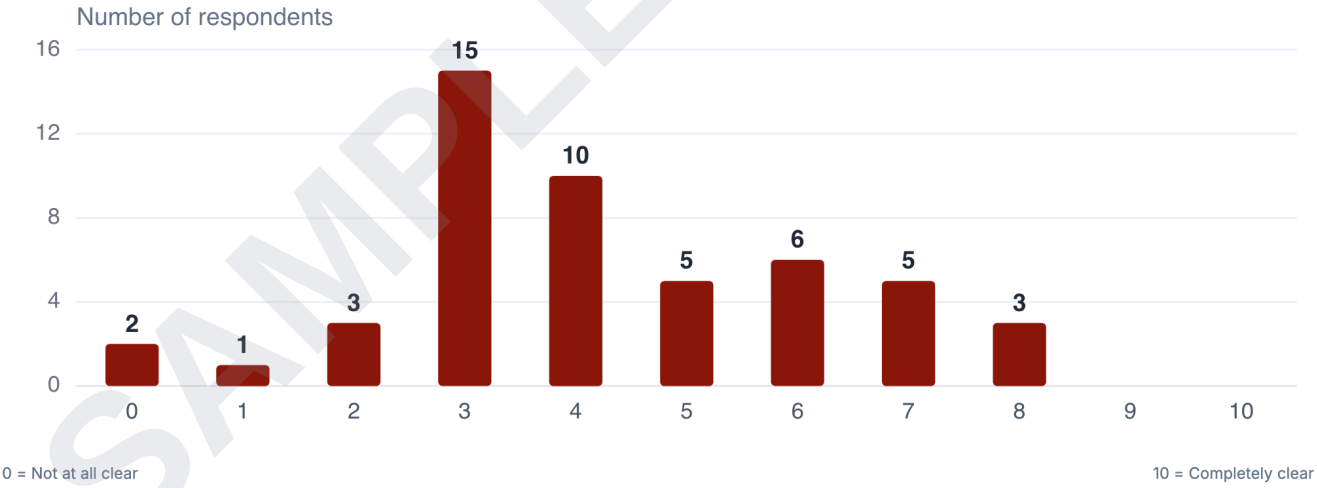


Answered by 50 respondents

Q7. How clear are career growth and promotion paths for someone in your sales role?

Responses indicate a lack of clarity for many, with over 60% rating it as low (0-4). Comments suggest that formal pathways are absent or unclear, and participants desire transparent timelines, published ladders, and structured development plans to enhance motivation and retention.

Summary includes follow-up responses.



Answered by 50 respondents

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Q8. What is the biggest obstacle to staying and succeeding on this sales team right now?

Key obstacles include insufficient leadership transparency, unclear growth and promotion plans, workload pressures, and operational hurdles like quota changes and onboarding issues. Many responses highlight the need for structural fixes, better communication, and managerial support to motivate participants to stay.

Summary includes follow-up responses.

Answered by 50 respondents · Open-text responses

ILLUSTRATIVE QUOTES

> *"I would stay if leadership published a 90-day attrition action plan and actually tracked it. Leadership has heard this before with little follow-through."*

> *"SPIFs help short-term, but base OTE and clarity on accelerators matter more for retention. It feels local to my manager, not company-wide."*

Q9. Which statement best describes collaboration within the sales team and with CS/SE partners?

A significant portion of responses describe inconsistent, blocked, or weak collaboration due to territorial disputes, poor handoffs, and culture issues. Follow-up comments underscore that cross-region competition and lack of effective processes hinder teamwork, potentially affecting morale and performance.

Summary includes follow-up responses.



Answered by 50 respondents - Single response

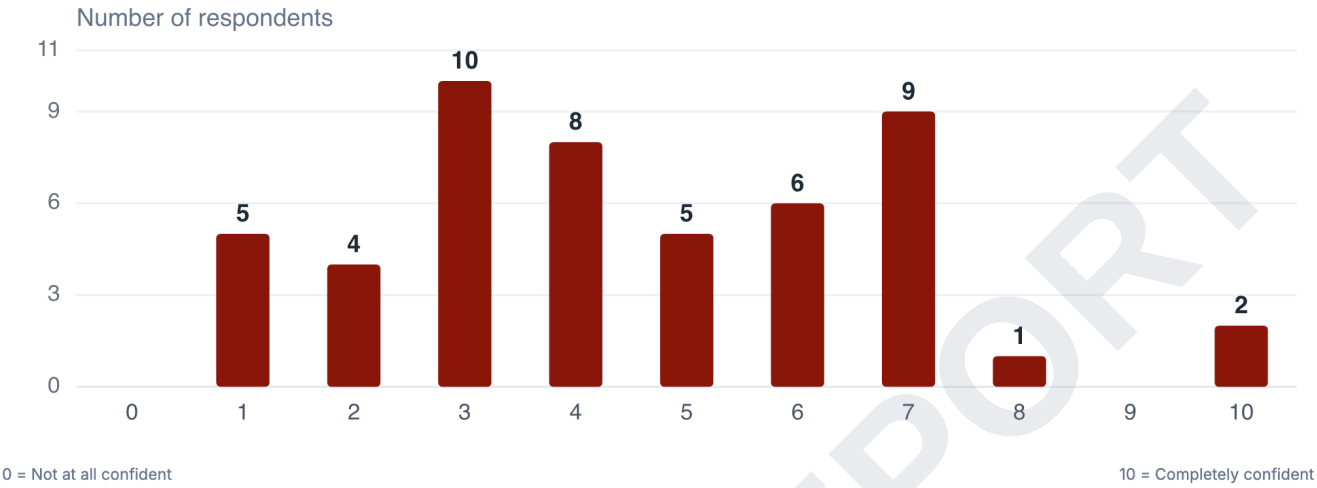
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Q10. How confident are you that feedback about sales attrition will lead to real action from leadership?

Overall confidence appears limited, with most responses indicating skepticism about leadership responsiveness. Follow-up comments point to unmet expectations for action, slow reaction times, and a lack of tangible results, demonstrating a trust gap.

Summary includes follow-up responses.



0 = Not at all confident

10 = Completely confident

Answered by 50 respondents

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Conclusions

The survey paints a picture of a sales team facing multiple challenges that threaten retention and engagement. Notably, trust in leadership and perceived support are low, with many participants citing poor communication, unclear career paths, and operational stressors as key drivers of departure. Work-life balance emerges as a critical concern, especially during peak periods, raising the risk of burnout. Recognition for contributions remains inconsistent, and collaboration often faces barriers rooted in territorial disputes and process flaws. Addressing these systemic issues through clear, transparent communication, structured career development, and workload management stands to improve morale and reduce attrition. Building trust and providing actionable feedback loops are essential for creating a sustainable, motivated sales environment.

Suggested Next Steps

1. **Enhance leadership communication and transparency.**

   Improving timely and transparent communication from leadership could rebuild trust and clarify organizational changes. This involves establishing regular updates, clear rationales for decisions, and an open forum for feedback, which may positively influence retention.

   Why recommended: Most participants report dissatisfaction with leadership communication, especially regarding decisions affecting quotas and territories, which impacts trust.

   Source Questions: Which area most drives sales team attrition in your experience? · How well does sales leadership communicate decisions that affect your quota, territory, or targets?

2. **Implement structured career pathways and promotion clarity.**

   Publishing explicit, measurable career ladders and development timelines can increase motivation and loyalty, reducing the sense of stagnation that leads employees to seek opportunities elsewhere.

   Why recommended: A majority find career growth paths vague or unclear, contributing to dissatisfaction and attrition risk.

   Source Question: How clear are career growth and promotion paths for someone in your sales role?

3. **Address workload balance and burnout risks.**

   Adjusting quotas, improving support, and establishing predictable schedules are crucial steps that can enhance sustainability, retain talent, and improve team morale.

   Why recommended: Most respondents report that workload and work-life balance are poor, especially during peak times, posing burnout risks.

   Source Question: How sustainable is your current sales workload and work-life balance?

4. **Foster a culture of recognition and fair reward.**

   Developing fair, regular acknowledgment mechanisms tailored to different achievement levels fosters motivation, enhances team cohesion, and supports long-term engagement.

   Why recommended: Recognition appears uneven, with mid-performance contributors feeling overlooked, impacting motivation and retention.

   Source Question: How valued do you feel for the deals and pipeline work you contribute?

5. **Improve collaboration processes and reduce friction.**

   Streamlining handoff processes, clarifying roles, and cultivating a collaborative culture will mitigate friction, boost morale, and potentially enhance performance.

   Why recommended: High levels of inconsistent and blocked collaboration reflect operational and culture barriers.

   Source Question: Which statement best describes collaboration within the sales team and with CS/SE partners?

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Session Details

SESSION CREATOR
John Doe

SESSION TYPE
Survey

SESSION NAME
Sales Team Attrition Insights Survey

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PARTICIPANT IDENTITY
Identified

SESSION DESCRIPTION

Survey to uncover why sales team members leave or consider leaving — covering leadership support, compensation and recognition, career growth, workload balance, and team collaboration.

50	100%	3 minutes	4 minutes
PARTICIPANTS	COMPLETION RATE	MIN. COMPLETION TIME	MAX. COMPLETION TIME

SURVEY OBJECTIVES AND SCOPE

The focus of this survey is to gather insights into the reasons behind sales team attrition within a sales organization, specifically examining factors such as leadership support and communication, compensation and recognition, career growth opportunities, workload and work-life balance, and team collaboration. The purpose is to identify actionable improvements that can reduce turnover, enhance team stability, and improve overall performance. The survey aims to assess employees' future intentions, perceptions of leadership communication, feelings of value and recognition, workload sustainability, clarity of career paths, major obstacles to success, collaboration dynamics, and leadership responsiveness to feedback. The intended outcome is to utilize these insights to implement targeted strategies that promote retention and elevate team effectiveness.

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BASE SURVEY QUESTIONS

1. Overall, how likely are you to still be on this sales team 12 months from now?
2. Which area most drives sales team attrition in your experience?
3. How well does sales leadership communicate decisions that affect your quota, territory, or targets?
4. Describe one change that would most reduce attrition on this sales team.
5. How valued do you feel for the deals and pipeline work you contribute?
6. How sustainable is your current sales workload and work-life balance?
7. How clear are career growth and promotion paths for someone in your sales role?
8. What is the biggest obstacle to staying and succeeding on this sales team right now?
9. Which statement best describes collaboration within the sales team and with CS/SE partners?
10. How confident are you that feedback about sales attrition will lead to real action from leadership?

PARTICIPANT PROFILE

Demographic data is not available for this session.

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